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NOTES FROM WORLD WAR II

The Assam Line and How Workshops Made Grenades and Tanks

AMERICANS TAKE OVER WITH JEEP LOCOS AND LONGER TRAINS

It is a well-known fact that during World War II, India provided the base for American operations in support of China in its war with Japan as part of the China Burma India (CBI) theatre. The CBI was the US' military designation during the war for the China and South-east Asian or India-Burma (IBT) theatres or war fields. Operational command of the Allied forces (including US forces) in the CBI was officially the responsibility of the Supreme Commanders for South-east Asia or China. However, US forces in practice helped in logistical, material and personnel matters .

Here is a fascinating account of how the lines in Assam were completely overhauled by the American soldiers during the wartime and the scale of operations in the north-east. It is reproduced from the November 1950 issue of Ex-CBI Roundup by Boyd Sinclair.

Running on Time in a Timeless Land

> Americans swarmed up and down railways over India, Burma and China; they put Jeeps into service for locomotive power and in north-east India tackled the big job of taking over and running most of the Assam Bengal Railway (ABR).
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> The Bengal and Assam Railway runs up through Bengal from Calcutta into upper Assam where Assam borders Burma. Across it runs the Brahmaputra river, which roughly parallels it most of the way. The railroad consists of a broad-gauge road north from